

The Good Management Company is a block and property management company based in London, dedicated to clear, responsive and transparent management of residential blocks and rental properties.

What good block and property management looks like

Management shapes how residents and owners experience the place they live in or invest in. Clear communication, transparent finances, proactive maintenance, genuine accountability. Here is the standard you should expect.

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What should good management include?

What are the core responsibilities of block and property management?

Managing common areas, coordinating maintenance, keeping accurate leaseholder and resident accounts, collecting service charges and rent, meeting building regulations, and keeping everyone informed. Done well, none of it is visible — residents and owners simply stop having to wonder whether things are being handled.

How should a management company charge for its services?

Transparently. You should know what you are paying for, how the fee is calculated, and what falls outside it. Hidden costs and charges that appear without explanation are the clearest early warning sign of a difficult relationship.

What makes maintenance management effective?

Planning rather than reacting. Vetted contractors, work that is properly overseen rather than simply instructed, records kept as a matter of course, and residents told what is happening before it happens. Emergencies are expensive; most of them were predictable.

Why does communication matter so much?

Because silence is what turns a minor problem into a dispute. Residents and owners should understand what is happening in their building, why decisions were taken, and where their money went. Most complaints about managing agents are, underneath, complaints about not being told.

What should you expect from financial management?

Accuracy, clarity and accountability. Statements that show where money actually went. Reserve funds planned and disclosed rather than discovered. Under the reforms now working through Parliament, leaseholders' rights to this information are being strengthened — but it should never have needed legislating.

How should complaints be handled?

Quickly, and by someone with the authority to fix the problem. Good management treats a complaint as information. One ignored is a warning sign. Several ignored is a failure of the arrangement itself.

What separates good management from bad?

Time horizon. Good management spends money now to avoid spending more later, communicates before being asked, keeps the finances legible, and treats the building as somewhere people live. Bad management treats it as a contract to be serviced at the lowest cost that avoids complaint.

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What the 2026 leasehold reforms actually mean for your block

The Good Management Company · 7 September 2026 · 6 min read

Leasehold reform has been announced so many times, and implemented so slowly, that most leaseholders have stopped following it. That is understandable, but it means a good deal of what has actually changed is being missed.

This is an account of where things stand: what is already law and affecting your building now, what has been published but not yet commenced, and what remains a proposal that may or may not survive.

What is already in force

Two changes took effect during 2025 and are worth knowing about because they are immediately usable. The two-year ownership requirement before extending a lease or buying a share of the freehold has gone; you can now apply from the day you complete. And the right to manage threshold has moved, so buildings with up to half their floor space in commercial use now qualify, where the limit used to be a quarter.

That second change matters more than it sounds. A great many London blocks sit above shops, and were previously shut out of taking over management of their own building.

What has been confirmed but not yet arrived

The government has committed to a set of service charge transparency measures: a standardised demand form, an annual report to leaseholders, and strengthened rights to request information. Most of this is expected to take effect from 2027 rather than now.

There is also a stated intention to regulate managing agents more tightly, including a consultation on mandatory professional qualifications. For an industry with no licensing requirement at all, that would be a significant change.

What is still only proposed

A Commonhold and Leasehold Reform Bill has been announced for the current parliamentary session, and a draft was published in January. It contains a proposed ground rent cap and a longer-term move towards commonhold for new flats. None of this is law, and the detail may change substantially before it is.

What to do about it

Little, in most cases, beyond knowing where you stand. If you have been putting off a lease extension because of the old ownership rule, that obstacle has gone. If your building has commercial space at ground level and you have previously been told right to manage was unavailable, it is worth checking again.

Beyond that, the transparency measures are coming whether or not your managing agent is ready for them. A reasonable question to ask now is whether your service charge accounts would survive being read carefully — because before long, more people will be reading them.

This article describes the position as at September 2026 and is general information rather than legal advice. Anyone making a decision about their own lease should take proper advice on it.

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Reading a service charge statement properly

The Good Management Company · 14 September 2026 · 7 min read

Most leaseholders glance at the total, wince, and file it. That is understandable, and it is also how overcharging survives for years without being noticed.

A service charge statement is not a bill in the ordinary sense. It is an account of money already spent on your behalf, and you have a statutory right to interrogate it. Here is what each part should tell you and what to do when it does not.

Start with the budget, not the demand

You should receive two documents each year: an estimate at the start and actual accounts at the end. Compare them. Small variances are normal. A category that comes in at double its estimate is a question, and a plausible answer exists in most cases — an unexpected roof repair, an insurance renewal that jumped. What should worry you is a large variance nobody thought to mention until the accounts arrived.

Look at what sits inside "management fee"

The management fee should cover the routine work: collecting service charges, arranging maintenance, keeping the accounts, dealing with correspondence. What it should not quietly cover is a second layer of charges for things a reasonable person would assume were included — a fee for issuing a demand, a fee for answering a solicitor's enquiry, a fee for sending a letter.

Some of those charges are legitimate and properly disclosed. The test is whether you were told about them before they appeared.

Check the reserve fund is real

A reserve fund exists so that a new roof in fifteen years does not arrive as a bill you cannot pay. It should be held separately, its balance should be stated, and there should be some reasoning behind the amount collected — ideally a survey setting out what will need replacing and when.

A reserve fund with no stated balance, or one that has been dipped into for day-to-day costs, is worth asking about directly.

Three questions worth asking every year

First, which items came in more than twenty per cent over estimate, and why. Second, when insurance was last put out to market — buildings insurance is often the largest single line, and commission arrangements are not always visible. Third, what the reserve fund balance is and what it is being held against.

A managing agent who answers those three readily is probably running the building properly. One who treats them as an imposition is telling you something.

What you are entitled to

You can request a summary of costs, and you can inspect the invoices behind them. These are statutory rights, not favours, and the transparency measures working through Parliament are expected to strengthen them further — standardised demand forms and an annual report among them.

None of that helps if nobody asks. The most useful thing a leaseholder can do is read the accounts once a year and put the questions in writing.

This article is general information rather than legal advice. Anyone in dispute over a service charge should take proper advice on their own lease.

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Replace with the quotation. Keep it in the client's own words — do not tidy the phrasing. Two or three sentences reads as real; a paragraph reads as written for us.

NAME, ROLE · TYPE OF BUILDING, AREA

Second quotation. Aim for ones that name a specific thing that happened rather than general praise — a problem solved, a deadline met, a cost avoided.

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Third quotation. Three good ones are worth more than eight thin ones.

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Get in touch

Whether you are a resident, a director of a residents' management company, or a landlord — ask a question about your building, or about how it is currently being managed.

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MESSAGE

SEND

We read everything that arrives and reply to all of it.

Or write to us directly at team@goodmanagement.co.uk

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Changes

This notice was last updated in September 2026. Any future change will be posted here.

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